Office Memorandum • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT

367

DATE: [illegible]

TO : [illegible]
[illegible] [redacted]

FROM : [illegible]

SUBJECT: Use of Office Of Consultants' Funds for C/S Contact

[illegible] : [illegible] - [illegible] [redacted]

1. In connection with [illegible], we have been advised by the Chief, CO that C/S Dr. [redacted] would be willing to undertake an investigation of bulbocapnine.

2. The source, Dr. [redacted] incumbent Professor of Psychiatry and Neurology and Chairman of the Department at [redacted] College of Medicine, [redacted] is well qualified in pursuing this inquiry on the effect of the drug on the central nervous system.

3. Following toxicity studies on monkeys, Dr. [redacted] plans to evaluate the drug on convicts incarcerated at the [redacted] State Penitentiary located at [redacted], approximately 125 miles from [redacted]. He believes the study, which would entail the purchase of the animals and care and his transportation, could be accomplished for a maximum of $500.00.

4. In that financial assistance for this project could be of considerable value in the assay of potential psychogenic drugs, it is recommended that Dr. [redacted] be ~~advanced~~ given the authority to spend up to $500.00 to cover required expenses.

[redacted]

[redacted]

Approved

[redacted]

COPY 367

[redacted]

DAS 5399
30 July 1956

US

Schizophrenic Agent

Case No. [redacted]

Background:

Bulbocapnine, the alkaloids of Dutchman's breeches (Corydalis cava) has received attention in various countries, including Russia. The most obvious effect recorded as a result of fairly large doses, was catatonia or stupor. Smaller doses caused symptoms resembling those of schizophrenia. Recent Russian studies dealt especially with the effects of bulbocapnine on higher divisions of the Central Nervous System and the cerebral cortex. Dr. [redacted] had offered to test the substance on man, but unfortunately died before he could complete his studies. Enclosed is a copy of a preliminary report from Dr. [redacted] and a copy of the translation of a recent Russian publication.

Requirements:

We desire to have certain psycho-chemical properties tested on man, using the bulbocapnine which we were fortunate to obtain from [redacted] a sample being enclosed herewith. More bulbocapnine is available, if needed.

Among the queries we should like to include the following:

Loss of speech, if any, in man, indicated in one case by Dr. [redacted]

Loss of sensitivity to pain, if any.

Loss of memory (observed in a single case by Dr. [redacted]).

Loss of will power, if any.

Increase in toxicity in persons with a weak type Central Nervous System. (see Page 21, No. 6, of Russian manuscript)

Effects on man, compared to effects on animals as recorded in conclusions. (see pages 20 and 21 of Russian manuscript)

January 1957
M/SI Mr. [redacted] (Dr. [redacted])

[redacted]

Chief, Collection Staff, [illegible]

This requirement pertains to National Priority Objective [illegible] and [illegible] collection priority [illegible].

CONFIDENTIAL

WITH CLASSIFICATION OF ATTACHED MATERIAL SHOULD BE CIRCLED TOP AND BOTTOM

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ACTION SHEET

	IC #
Internal Research Project	DATED
Chief, Administration Branch	TO
Investigation and Report on Bulbocapnine	
	DEADLINE DATE / FOLLOW-UP DATE

DIVISION ROUTING

TO	DATE	ACTION REQUIRED	INIT.
Ch/Admin.	[illegible]		[illegible]
Executive	11/13/56	Review	[illegible]
DAD/C	13 Nov		[illegible]
DAD/P	14 Nov		[illegible]
AD/SI	14 Nov	Approval	[illegible]
Budget Officer		Reproduction	

COMMENTS*

Approved in principle 5 November 1956

DAD/P [illegible] this shape? [illegible]

This is part of our support to Artichoke?

Recommend it be OK'd.

Recommend approval in principle, as redrafted.

INSTRUCTIONS: Under each comment a line should be drawn across sheet and each comment numbered to correspond with the number in the "TO" Column.

* If comments bear a higher classification than the attached material, the security classification of this sheet be changed.

56-60A

FORM NO. 75-3 (REPLACES FORM 30-19, WHICH MAY BE USED UNTIL SUPPLY IS EXHAUSTED)

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